

The *whole note* is held for four counts.

The *half note* is held for two counts.

The *quarter note* is held for one count.

The *eighth note* is held for half a count.

The *sixteenth note* is held for a quarter of a count.

Counts: 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4

Note: When two or more eighth notes or sixteenth notes are notated next to each other, their tails are replaced by a beam as shown below.

tail + tail = beam

tail + tail + tail + tail = beam

Whole Notes

The first of the common rhythms we are going to look at consists of *whole notes*. Whole notes can also be called *semibreves*. Each whole note is worth 4 counts. Press play on the audio track below and listen to the rhythm notated below. As mentioned earlier, the audio track has a metronome playing along to help you stay in time with the music. After listening to it, and when you are ready, press play again and either play along (note E) or clap the rhythm.



Semibreve/Whole Note Rhythm

Half Notes

Half notes can also be called *minims*. Each half note is worth 2 counts. Press play on the audio track below and listen to the rhythm notated below. After listening to it, press play again and either play along or clap the rhythm.



Minim/ Half Note Rhythm

Quarter Notes

Quarter notes can also be called *crotchets*. Each quarter note is worth 1 count. Press play on the audio track below and listen to the rhythm notated below. After listening to it, press play again and either play along or clap the rhythm.



Crotchet/ Quarter Note Rhythm

Eighth Notes

Eighth notes can also be called *quavers*. Each eighth note is worth half a count. Press play on the audio track below and listen to the rhythm notated below. The first 3 bars are eighth notes and the fourth bar is a whole note. After listening to it, press play again and either play along or clap the rhythm.



Quaver/Eighth Note Rhythm

Sixteenth Notes

Sixteenth notes can also be called *semiquavers*. Each sixteenth note is worth a quarter of one count. Press play on the audio track below and listen to the rhythm notated below. After listening to it, press play again and either play along or clap the rhythm.



Semiquaver/Sixteenth Note Rhythm

Triplets

You play three eighth notes in the time of two eighth notes when you play a triplet. That is, you play three eighth notes in one beat. Triplets are notated as three eighth notes joined together with the number 3 written above it. Press play on the audio track below and listen to the rhythm notated below. After listening to it, press play again and either play along or clap the rhythm.



Triplet Rhythm

One Eighth Note and Two Sixteenth Notes

The two rhythms that follow are a combinations of the common rhythms that you have just learnt. Below is a rhythm that combines eighth notes and sixteenth notes. Press play on the audio track below and listen to the rhythm notated below. After listening to it, press play again and either play along or clap the rhythm.



One Eighth Note and Two Sixteenth Notes Rhythm

Two Sixteenth Notes and One Eighth Note Rhythm

The rhythm below features 2 sixteenth notes followed by 1 eighth note. Press play on the audio track below and listen to the rhythm notated below. After listening to it, press play again and either play along or clap the rhythm.



Two Sixteenth Notes and One Eighth Note Rhythm

Dotted Eighth Note And Sixteenth Note

A dotted eighth note is also called a *dotted quaver*. It is worth three quarters of one count. Press play on the audio track below and listen to the rhythm notated below. After listening to it, press play again and either play along or clap the rhythm.



Dotted Eighth Note and Sixteenth Note Rhythm

Sixteenth Note and Dotted Eighth Note

The last of the common rhythms in this article features a sixteenth note followed by a dotted eighth note. As previously, press play on the audio track below and listen to the rhythm notated below. After listening to it, press play again and either play along or clap the rhythm.



Sixteenth Note and Dotted Eighth Note Rhythm